

4. Suppose, you are the coordinator of a local youth club. Now, write an email to announce the date of picnic to the members of the club.
5. Suppose, you are a student of class VIII. You know that a music festival is very helpful to drive the monotony of school activities. Now write an email to the Headteacher of your school permitting you to organize a music festival in your school after the final examination.

DEVELOPING COMPOSITION

What is a composition?

A composition contains a number of paragraphs which discuss one main idea. The main idea is the 'topic' which you are going to write about. A good composition has the same basic patterns as a paragraph does.

THE STRUCTURE OF A COMPOSITION

A composition has three main sections. These are ***introduction, body, conclusion***.

How to write the 'Introduction' of your composition

The first paragraph of your composition is the **introduction**. It states the main idea of your composition. The introduction should be attractive or strong enough to catch the attention of the readers. The most important part of the introduction is **to tell what you are going to write about**. Just as the topic sentence of a paragraph states the main idea of a paragraph, an introductory paragraph expresses the main idea of a composition. It is usually a single sentence.

The Introduction tells the subject of your composition and makes a clear statement about your topic.

How to write the 'body' of your composition

The body of a composition consists of different paragraphs. But each paragraph of the body focuses one idea. Again, this idea should support what is stated in the introduction. In the body of the composition, the main idea of the introduction is narrated, explained and analysed.

To write the body of your composition:

- Write one supporting idea in one paragraph.
- Each paragraph of your composition must contain a topic sentence, a middle and a conclusion.
- Support your idea with examples and explanations as clearly as possible.

How to 'end' your composition (conclusion)

This section sums up the idea presented in the composition

The difference between introduction and conclusion:

- The introduction states what you are going to write.
- The conclusion sums up what you have already written.

KINDS OF COMPOSITION

Composition can be of many types. However, the major kinds are:

- narrative
- descriptive
- persuasive
- informative/ expository

Narrative

It tells a story or presents a sequence of events as they occurred in time. The purpose of this is to give the readers an impression of actual event. Here, 'what happened' and 'how happened' are discussed.

- It is about historical events or accounts of people's life and events.
- It answers questions like *who, what, when, where and how*.

Descriptive

It is like describing a person, place or thing including details that appeal to the readers. This kind of paragraph appeals to our five senses— sight, smell, hearing, touch and taste.

It describes

- the details about a place, event, person or thing
- ways they attract our senses

Persuasive

It contains arguments. Writers try to give some reasons to support their arguments.

It contains

- arguments one after another
- reasons supported by clear ideas

Informative/ Expository: It explains facts or ideas. It also explains the process.

Read the following example of developing composition on 'The Season You Like Most'. Read the first two statements and decide which one is more appropriate for an introduction.

Not a good
introduction

There are six seasons in Bangladesh and spring is one of them. It is called the king of all seasons.

Good
introduction

The beauty of spring is different from the rest of the seasons. I like it for many reasons such as its beautiful colours, fragrances and decorations.

Conclusion

Spring is my favourite season. I like it very much because its beauty is different from all other seasons.

The body of the composition

In a short composition, the body includes three or four paragraphs. In each paragraph you will write about only one idea. Thus, in a composition of 200 words, you can write three or four major ideas. But remember that all paragraphs of the body should support the main idea you provided in the *introduction*.

- description of spring
- its beauty
- how is it different from other seasons

Spring in Bangladesh



Spring in Bangladesh

The topic sentence ← The beauty of spring is different from the rest of the seasons. I like it for many reasons such as its beautiful colours, fragrances and decorations.

Supporting ideas/body ← According to Bangla calendar, the months of Falgun and Chaitra are called the spring. The weather of this season is neither hot nor cold. Spring gives us relief from winter. During spring nature seems calm and quiet. The sky looks clear and there are no natural disasters like storms, cyclones, draughts, etc. during spring. Thus the physical atmosphere of spring is wonderful.

Supporting ideas/body ← With the advent of spring, nature puts on a lively appearance. Every object of nature becomes fresh. Trees are decorated with new leaves. Flowers bloom in every plants, trees and herbs. The flowers are of different colours. Some of them are sweet-smelling, some have no smell, but all are beautiful. So bees and butterflies are everywhere.

Supporting ideas/body ← As soon as spring sets in, a gentle breeze from the south begins to blow. It spreads the sweet smell of flowers all-around. The wandering song of the cuckoo attracts us a lot. It touches the heart of the poet and writers. Many poets have written poems and songs about spring.

Conclusion ← Spring is the most colorful and beautiful season in Bangladesh. It has a deep influence on our sight and mind. I love it so much. It is my most favourite season.

Note: You must have noticed that the **first paragraph** describes the physical features of spring. **The second paragraph** tells us about the boundless beauty of spring. Here we have a wider description of spring. **The third paragraph** describes the influence of spring on human mind and heart. Thus different paragraphs of a body give us different and separate ideas. But these must support the main idea.

Developing Composition-Sample-1



Suppose, you are asked to write a composition on **A Village Market** in 200 words.

Include the following points:

- i) What is a village market?
- ii) When does it start?
- iii) What are the activities?
- iv) How does it help the villagers?
- v) Why is it so important?

Now look at the sample composition and try to understand how we develop different parts of a composition gradually.

Introduction It states the main idea –village market. The sentence in bold is the thesis statement.	A Village Market A village market is a place where the villagers meet to buy and sell things. It is centre for buying and selling for villagers and a hub of economic activities.
Body Each paragraph in the body develops different ideas mentioned in the thesis statement.	Generally a village market sits every morning and evening. However, big markets sit once or twice in a week. The daily market is called the bazaar and the weekly market is known as the haat. It is a prime business centre in the villages. People come here to buy and sell different goods.
Body This paragraph contains a topic sentence. It also supports the main idea.	A village market is a busy place with a lot of economic activities. In the open space the sellers sit in rows. Farmers, potters, weavers sell their products such as fish, milk, fruits, betel leaves, vegetables, etc. Some grocers, tailors, doctors have their permanent shops to sell oil, rice, salt, pepper, medicine, fertilizers, etc. It is a crowded place and people stay there until about 9 o'clock in the evening.
Body This paragraph describes another aspect of a village market.	The village market is very useful to the villagers. Here they get most things of their daily use. It saves the villagers from going to distant places to buy things. Moreover, it is a meeting place for the villagers.
Conclusion	The village market does a great service to the rural people. It is the backbone of the rural economy.

N.B. 'Thesis statement' = the main idea of a piece of composition.

Developing Composition – Sample 2**Kazi Nazrul Islam**

Suppose, you are asked to write a composition on ‘Your Favourite Poet’ in 200 words. Do not forget to include the following points:

- i) Who your favourite poet is
- ii) Where he was born
- lii) His education
- iv) His major works
- v) Why he is your favourite

Your Favourite Poet

Introduction <i>It states the main idea- Kazi Nazrul Islam The bold sentence is the thesis statement</i>	Kazi Nazrul Islam is my favourite poet. He wrote poems, songs, ghazals, etc . He is known as ‘rebel poet’. He is famous for his poetry and songs. He is also the national poet of Bangladesh.
Body <i>Each paragraph in the body develops different ideas mentioned in the thesis statement.</i>	Kazi Nazrul Islam was born at Churulia, a village in Burdwan, West Bengal of India. He was born on 25 May, 1899. His father's name was Kazi Fakir Ahamed and that of his mother was Zaheda Khatun.
Body <i>This paragraph contains a topic sentence. It also supports the main idea</i>	Nazrul Islam received religious education. He was a student of the Maktab of his village. Though he was a brilliant student, he could not complete his education.
Body <i>Tells about his famous works</i>	He was very famous for his poems. Among them, he wrote “Bidrohi” in 1922. It became very popular among people. This is the poem which makes him a ‘rebel’. He is also famous for his songs. He wrote about 4000 songs known as Nazrul Geeti. He is also famous for his ghazals. His famous works include <i>Agni Bina</i> , <i>Bisher Bashi</i> , <i>Chakrabak</i> , <i>Shindu Hindol</i> , and <i>Aleya</i> .
Conclusion <i>Contains a concluding statement.</i>	He was a versatile writer. Nazrul died in Dhaka on August 29, 1976. He will be remembered by the nation forever for his greatness.

Model 1

Instruction: Many students try to write paragraphs, compositions or letters themselves while others memorize them. Which is better?



Discuss the answers in groups or in pairs. Now write a composition and give your reasons to support your point.

Memorization Versus Self-writing

The writing of composition, letters or paragraphs is a part of creative writing. But many students do not try to write them themselves. On the other hand, they try to memorize them. The memorization of composition is difficult and boring.

Many of us think that writing is a very difficult task. So, they think that memorization is much easier. Thus, they do not even try to practise it. Another reason for memorization is that most of the topics are often repeated in the tests. So, students, without thinking much start memorizing.

Writing develops slowly and gradually. For this one should think that he can write and he must try. It is a step by step process. If one can make sentences, s/he can write. If one can point out information, can describe about people, place or things, one makes rapid progress in writing. Moreover, discussing with classmates or with teachers can make writing easier.

Memorization is boring and difficult because we have to spend long period of time for this. Again it is risky as there are lots of topics. So to depend on memorization is like depending on luck.

It is not possible to memorize all things and it is not creative. I think if we try, we may write by ourselves. It will increase our confidence and scores in a test.

Task 1

Instruction: Some people prefer to live in a village. Others prefer to live in a city. Which place would you prefer to live in? Give some reasons with examples and explanations. Now write a short composition on **City Life Versus Country Life**.

Model 2

Instruction: The Internet is a popular mode of communication. It has saved our time. It has made communication easier than ever. Do you think that the Internet helps us in multiple ways? If so, explain them and write a short composition on **The Internet**.

The Internet

At present the Internet is the most powerful communication system or device. For personal, academic, business and social communication the internet is the strongest mode of communication. It has made our communication faster easier and cheaper.

The Internet is used for personal and social communication. People can send email and chat on the Internet. Email is a private communication and goes from one user to another. On the other hand, online chat can happen between two people or between groups.

Business communication largely depends on the Internet. Now most of the business transactions are done through the Internet. Our banks are providing different services through the Internet. Now we can deposit and withdraw money, pay bills, buy tickets and do many other things by using the Internet.

The Internet is very useful for students. Academic materials are stored online. Students can download and upload useful materials when necessary. Students now can attend real classes from a distance through the Internet. One can visit most of the libraries of the world through the Internet.

The Internet has brought the whole world in our hands. It is connecting people across the world despite social, racial and economic differences. It has made our life much easier than ever.

Task 2

Instruction: The computer can help us in many ways. Now write a short composition to show how it can help your learning.

Model 3

Suppose you have recently made a journey by train. The journey was very interesting and full of excitement. You still think about it. Now discuss with your classmates and write a short composition on it.



Instruction: A journey by train is different from other journeys in many ways. Suppose recently you have made a journey by train. You enjoyed it much. Now discuss with your partners and write a composition on **A Journey by Train**

A Journey by Train

A journey by train is getting popular in our country. Recently I have made a journey by train. It was full of excitements and thrills. Perhaps I will never forget it.

During our last winter vacation, my eldest uncle sent me an email. In the mail he asked me to visit him. I was very excited to spend a few days there because my school was closed. My uncle then worked at Jessore. So, I decided to go there by train.

It was 26 December. I got early in the morning. I took my breakfast. My mother gave me some snacks which I kept in my traveling bag. My sister Runy who is two years senior to me, gave me a book to read on the train. Then I hired a rickshaw and went to the rail station. I reached there at around 9.45 in the morning.

It was Ishwardy rail station. It was crowded with people of different trades and professions. I noticed that there were many ticket counters for different trains. I bought a ticket for the Sunderban Express. It was a 10.15 train and it reached the station at 10.13. I got on the train.

The train started at 10.20. All passengers looked very cheerful. At first it was moving at a slow speed. Suddenly I noticed that it was making a loud noise and we were on the Hardinge Bridge. It is the oldest iron bridge of our country. I could also see the Lalon Shah Bridge just parallel to the Hardinge Bridge. The bridge has connected Pabna and Kushtia Districts.

It was around 11 o'clock and the train was running at a high speed. I could see through the window that all trees along the rail track seemed to go backwards rapidly. It was amazing. We were leaving trees, plants, rivers, ponds, green fields, cattle, villages, houses and human beings behind us. It stopped at Veramara, Alamdanga only for a few minutes. It reached Jessore at 4 o'clock in the afternoon. When I got down the train I found that my uncle was waiting there. It was a boundless joy for me to see my uncle.

A journey by train is really a blessing of modern transportation system. If you get on it, you will feel safe and sound.

Task 3

Instruction: Suppose you have recently made a journey by boat. The journey was very interesting and full of excitement. You still remember it. Now discuss with your classmates and write a short composition on it.

Model 4

Instruction: Reading a newspaper is a good habit. It is said that the newspaper is a storehouse of knowledge. Now discuss in groups about how you can be benefited by reading newspapers. After the discussion, write a short composition on it.



Reading the Newspaper

The newspaper is a good source of news or information. By reading newspapers, we can learn about many events of the present and the past. It is really a storehouse of events.

The newspaper gives us everyday information. When we go through it, we come to know about different events around us. Thus newspapers can enrich our knowledge about the world.

The newspaper not only contains news but also views on different national and international issues. The views are very important because they make us think of them from different angles. Thus it influences our understanding about different political, economic and social issues.

Newspaper reading is also very important for students. It develops their reading habit. They can also collect different educational materials from it. The newspaper also gives us some helpful suggestions on how to study different subjects. So, students read them and prepare themselves for examinations.

Reading the newspaper is really a good habit. By reading newspapers, we can understand the world. It is a good way to enrich our knowledge about the world.

Task 4

Instruction: Reading story books is a good habit. It is said that it widens our knowledge. Now discuss in groups how you can be benefited by reading story books. After the discussion, write a short composition on it.

Model 5

Instruction: Do you think that tree plantation is an important act to save the environment? Discuss in groups and point out why tree plantation is essential? Why should we plant more and more trees? Now write a short composition on **Tree Plantation**.



Tree Plantation

Plants and trees are closely connected with our life and well-being. The benefits we get from them are countless. Trees are essential for us because they have made our life livable on earth.

Trees are most important for maintaining ecological balance. Trees can save us from different natural disasters like floods, draughts and cyclones.

Our life and trees are inseparable. For these reasons, we should plant more and more trees. If we want to save our lives on earth, we must plant trees. We should take care of them as we take care of ourselves. We must prevent those who cut down trees aimlessly.

We get some direct benefits from trees. They provide shelter, food, fruits, fodder, wood and timber. We also get medicine from different plants and trees. These are called medicinal plants. Trees give us oxygen, without which we cannot even think of living even for a minute.

Trees are vital for our life and living. Without trees and forests, we cannot think of our own life on earth. Therefore, we all should realize this truth and plant and protect more and more trees.

Task 5

Instruction: Many people kill birds for many reasons. But, we all know that they are important for us in many ways. Now, discuss in groups about the matter and write a composition on it.

Model 6

Instruction: Many students of your age want to be doctors, engineers and pilots. Many of them think of becoming teachers, scientists and police officers. Do you have a plan like this? What do you want to be in your life? Think deeply about that. You can also share your plan with your partners. Now write a short composition about your future career plan. You must describe what you want to be and why you want to be that.

My Career Plan

Careers are the types of work and activities that people prefer to do. A career means the job a person does until retirement. I have a plan about my future and I want to be a doctor.

I want to be a doctor for many reasons. It is a noble profession. A doctor can do a lot for people and society. When fall ill, we go to the doctor. It is a doctor who cures us from many diseases. When we feel very helpless, doctors stand beside us and help us to overcome our sufferings.

The social status of a doctor is also very high in a society. Everyone in the society respects the doctors. When I become a doctor, I will help people

around me. I will stay in a village because in the villages, we do not have many doctors. Therefore, people do not get proper treatment.

I have seen that at times, different health camps are organized where expert doctors give free treatment to patients who attend the programme. These charitable activities inspire me a lot. I often dream that one day I will also serve the suffering people.

Therefore, I have a great desire to be a doctor. People may have different professions. People do different things to contribute to the society. But I only think of becoming a good doctor.

Task 6

Instruction: Suppose, your parents want you to become a doctor. But you want to be a teacher. Now discuss in groups about your dream and write a composition on it.

Tasks for Practice

1. Many people believe that watching television has a negative effect on students because it reduces their study time. Do you agree or disagree? Use specific reasons and examples to support your response. You could include:

- i) When does watching television become harmful?
- ii) Is it altogether a waste of time?
- iii) How does it affect your study?
- iv) How can you get benefit from it?

2. We all have favorite activities that we enjoy. Write an essay trying to convince your readers why you enjoy it most.

You could also include the following points:

- i) What is your favourite activity?
- ii) When do you do it?
- iii) Why is it your favourite?
- iv) Does it have social and economic values?

3. Have you ever travelled to a place that you found very significant and interesting? Write an essay that persuades others to visit this important place.

- i) Name of the place
- ii) Detailed location of the place
- iii) Significance of the place
- iv) Summary of your experience

4. Is there a book that you feel should be read by everyone? Write an essay persuading your friends to read this book.

You can also include the following points:

- i) Name of the book and its writer
- ii) Main theme of the book
- iii) Main attraction of the book
- iv) Your opinion about the book

5. What is friendship? How can it help us? What are the essential qualities of friendship? How can friends help you prepare your lessons? Now discuss in pairs and write a short composition on **Friendship**.

6. Is there any person who you think as your role model? Who is he/she? Why do you want to be like him/her? Why do you want to be like him/her? Write a short composition on **The Person You Like Most.**
7. It has been said that television has little real educational value. What is your opinion on this issue? Write an essay stating your opinion in details. The topic of the essay will be **The Educational Value of Television.**
8. Are you familiar with online classes? Do you think them to be helpful? How are they different from formal classroom teaching? Why more and more students are attending online classes? How can they contribute to education? Now discuss in groups or in pairs and write a short composition on **The Merits of Online Classes.**
9. What is a science fair? What is the importance if it? How can it influence our students? Suppose you have recently attended a science fair. Now write a short composition on **The Importance of a Science Fair.**
10. Student life is very important for multiple reasons. Do you think that the future success of a student largely depends on the habit that a student maintains during student life? Discuss in groups or in pairs about the importance of student life and write a composition on **The Importance of Student Life.**

Sample Question
Subject: English 2nd Paper
Grade: Eight

Time: 2 hours

Marks: 50

[Marks for individual items are mentioned next to the test items]

Part A: Grammar

1. Complete the text using the words in the box as needed. 5x10=05

It was (a)____ early morning when Sarah decided to go for (b) ____ walk in the park. The sun was shining (c) ____, and the birds were chirping (d) _____. As she walked, she noticed an old man sitting (e) ____ a bench reading a newspaper. Being (f) ____, she approached him and said, “Good morning, It’s such a beautiful day, isn’t it?” The old man smiled and replied, “Yes, (g) ____ I enjoy coming here every morning to read and (h) ____ in the fresh air.” Sarah sat beside him and they started (i) ____ about life. She realized that sometimes, a simple (j) ____ can teach us valuable lessons.

2. Make five meaningful sentences from the following substitution table. 1x5=05

Good friends	make	the foundation of a strong friendship.
Real friends	is	by your side, even in difficult times.
Trust and honesty	stands	every moment special and meaningful.
Friendship	are	laughter, secrets and unforgettable memories.
A true friend always	share	a precious bond that brings joy and support.

3. Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verbs given in the brackets.**1x5=05**

Reading a good book is one of the best ways to relax. It can also be a good material of (a)____(learn) new things. A well-written book takes you to a different world, (b)____(fill) with adventure and imagination. It helps (c)____(improve) vocabulary, knowledge and critical thinking skills. When I read a great book, I feel completely (d)____(absorb) in the story and forget everything around me. A good book is like a true friend that (e)____(stay) with you forever.

4. Rewrite the following passage in the reported speech.**1x5=05**

“Have you ever seen such a beautiful sunset?” asked Sinthia as she pointed at the sky. “It looks like a painting,” replied Nishat with admiration. “How quickly the colours are changing!” said Monia. “I wish we could stay here forever,” said Shaily with a smile. “Please take a picture to remember this moment,” said Nishat to Sinthia.

5. Change the following sentences as directed in brackets.**1x5=05**

- (a) The cake was baked by my grandmother for the party.(Make it Active)
- (b) It was the most delicious dessert I had ever tasted. (Make it Positive)
- (c) Unfortunately, not everyone got a slice because it was gone too quickly. (Make it Affirmative)
- (d) Please save a piece for me next time.(Make it Assertive)
- (e) It was a very incredible treat.(Make it Exclamatory)

6. Use appropriate punctuation marks and capital letters where necessary.

5x10=05

Dhrubo rushed into the room and shouted guess what I won the competition his sister clapped excitedly and said thats amazing tell me everything.

Part B: Writing

7. Suppose, you are Anil/Anila and your friend's name is Sadi/Sadia. Now, write an email to your friend advising him/her to make at least one

Technology-Free day in a week.

08

8. Write a short composition on "A Dream Place That You Want to Visit" in 250 words.

12**Probable Answers**

1. a) an
- b) a
- c) brightly
- d) happily
- e) on
- f) curious
- g) indeed
- h) relax
- i) talking
- j) conversation

2.
 - a) Good friends share laughter, secrets, and unforgettable memories.
 - b) Real friends stand by your side, even in difficult times.
 - c) Trust and honesty make the foundation of a strong friendship.
 - d) Friendship is a precious bond that brings joy and support.
 - e) A true friend always makes every moment special and meaningful.
3.
 - a) learning
 - b) filled
 - c) improve
 - d) absorbed
 - e) stays
4. Sinthia asked if they had ever seen such a beautiful sunset as she pointed at the sky. Nishat replied with admiration that it looked like a painting. Monia exclaimed that the colours were changing so quickly. Shaily with a smile wished that they could stay there forever. Nishat requested Sinthia to take a picture to remember that moment.
5.
 - a) My grandmother baked the cake for the party.
 - b) No other dessert I had ever tasted was as delicious as it.
 - c) Unfortunately, some people missed a slice because it was gone too quickly.
 - d) You should save a piece for me next time./You are requested to save a piece for me next
 - e) What an incredible treat it was!
6. Dhrubo rushed into the room and shouted, "Guess what? I won the competition!" His sister clapped excitedly and said, "That's amazing! Tell me everything."

Guidelines for question setters and markers for English

1. Multiple Choice Questions (MCQ)

MCQ can be set for testing a number of strategies and skills related to reading such as scanning, skimming, reading for gist, inferencing (guessing the meaning from the context) comprehension check etc. Each MCQ item will carry $\frac{1}{2}$ mark. However, depending on the level of difficulty some items may have 1 mark as well.

In preparing MCQ item, question setters will make sure that learners have to apply certain skills or strategies of reading in order to be able to choose the right options. Depending on the level of the learners, items will be set to test learners' lower order thinking skills (knowing and understanding) as well as higher order and more critical thinking (analyzing, synthesizing, and evaluating). Use synonyms in the questions to avoid quoting directly from the original passage. Make the questions a bit round about so that learners think.

For example :

Text : The Great Wall of China, one of the greatest wonders of the world, was first built between 220-206 BC.

Question : When was the Great Wall first built? (Don't make this type of question. Student will just get the answer from the question paper as 'was born' is common in both the text in the question paper and the answer.)

Question : What is the initial construction period of the Great Wall? (This question is Okay as learners has to understand that 'was built' and 'construction period' are same.)

Students will write the question number and then write only a/b/c/d that refers to the correct answer. Whole sentence from the question paper is not required.

The same text can be used for guessing the meaning from the context and Question Answer (open ended and close ended). However, the same text **cannot** be used for Question-Answer and True/False. Depending on difficulty level and text length, information transfer and True/False questions can be set from the same text or from two different texts. Two different texts are preferred to a single text.

Please note the following points while setting MCQ test items :

- Phrase stems as clearly as possible. Confusing questions can generate wrong answers from students who do understand the material.

- Avoid redundant words and phrases in the stem. Extraneous details make a question more complex and less reliable.
- Include any language in the stem that you would have to repeat in each answer option.
- Options should be similar in length and structure.
- The number of answer options should not be more than four.
- Distracters must be incorrect, but plausible. Try to include among the distracters options that contain common errors.
- To make distracters more plausible, use words that is familiar to students.
- If a recognizable key word appears in the correct answer, it should appear in some or all of the distracters as well. Don't let a verbal clue decrease the validity of your exam.
- Avoid using extreme or vague words in the answers. Use rarely extreme words like *all*, *always* and *never* or vague words or phrases like *usually*, *typically* and *may be* in the answers.
- Avoid using *All of the above* or *None of the above* as an answer choice.

In designing MCQs the following class wise guidelines have to be followed.

MCO for grades 6 and 7

Altogether 10 MCQs will be set. Each MCQ will have $\frac{1}{2}$ mark (or half mark) for a correct answer. There should be 6 MCQs on vocabulary test (guessing meaning from the context) and 4 MCQs on answering questions (scanning for specific information, search reading, deducing the meaning of unfamiliar words). Thus the marks distribution will be:

Vocabulary $\frac{1}{2} \times 6 = 3$

Questions $\frac{1}{2} \times 4 = 2$

Total = 5

MCO for grade 8

As given in NCTB Sample Question.

MCQ for grades 9-10

Altogether 7 MCQs will be set. Each MCQ will have 1 mark for a correct answer. There will be 2 MCQs on vocabulary test (guessing meaning from the context and inferencing) and 5 MCQs on answering questions (skimming, reading for main ideas and supporting details, reading to infer meaning). Thus the marks distribution will be:

Vocabulary 1X2 = 2

Questions 1X5 = 5

Total = 7

2. True/False

True-false questions are typically used to measure the ability to identify whether statements of fact are correct. The questions are usually a declarative statement that the student must judge as true or false.

Follow the general guidelines below while writing True/False items for your students:

- Base the item on a single idea.
- Write items that test an important idea.
- Avoid lifting statements right from the text.
- Make the statements as brief as possible.
- Write clearly true or clearly false statements.
- Try to avoid such words as *all, always, never, only, nothing, and alone*.
- The use of words like *more, less, important, unimportant, large, small, recent, old, tall, great*, and so on, can easily lead to ambiguity.
- State items positively. Negative statements may be difficult to interpret. This is especially true of statements using the double negative. If a negative word, such as "not" or "never," is used, be sure to underline or capitalize it.
- Beware of detectable answer patterns.

3. Matching

There is no need of a separate reading text for matching. The question itself will have a context after the texts in part A and part B are properly matched. The numbering of texts in column A can be i, ii, iii, iv and the texts in column B can be a, b, c, d..... Students only need to match the numbering in the two columns, e.g i, ii, iii, iv etc. (in column A) and a, b, c, d etc. (in column B). You can also use 3 columns with texts to match.

4. Gap filling with or without clues

The text in the gap filling activity is separate and complete. The text for this item will have a meaningful context too. There will be five gaps in the text. The gaps can be used

for article, preposition, or any other parts of speech without verb as there is separate test for it. A question setter will choose one particular item mentioned earlier to set a question and use a gap at the particular place. For example, if the question setter wants to test the article then there will be a gap at the position of a, an, the or before a noun that does not take any article. For a question of 3 marks, there will be six gaps in the text; for 4, there will be 8 gaps; and for 5 marks there will be ten gaps.

Follow the guidelines while writing gap filling test items:

- Prepare a scoring key that contains all acceptable answers for each item.
- Prefer single word or short phrase answers.
- Beware of open questions that invite unexpected but reasonable answers.
- Make all the blanks of an equal length.
- Avoid grammatical clues such as "an."
- Place the blanks near the end of the statement. Try to present a complete or nearly complete statement before calling for a response.
- Limit the number of blanks to one or two per sentence. Statements with too many blanks waste time as students figure out what is being asked.
- If a numerical answer is called for, indicate the units (e.g. currency) in which it is to be expressed.

5. Cloze test with/without clues

A cloze test is a fill-in-the-blank activity that assesses students' comprehension of vocabulary and reading passages or knowledge of grammatical items. In cloze tests there are recurrent gaps at every 4th, 5th, 6th or 7th word. If the first gap, for example, is used at the 5th place, all through the text the gap will be at the 5th place. Unlike the gap filling activity that tests a particular grammar item (e.g. preposition, article, pronoun, or verb) it is a test for vocabulary (key words) in general. This is why gap filling activity in the reading section is usually a cloze test. In contrast, gap filling activity is a merely a grammar test item.

A cloze test with 5 marks will have ten gaps (.5 for each gap). Considering the level of difficulty cloze tests without clues at grade 10 can have 5 gaps (1 mark for each gap).

In answering the question, an examinee does not need to reproduce the text in the answer script. Writing the missing word with the corresponding question number is enough. However, the whole text with suitable words in the gaps will neither earn any extra credit or discredit.

6. Information Transfer

Depending on the level of difficulty and length of the text, information transfer and True/False questions can be set from the same text. However, if the text is too small, **do**

not use the same text for both the tests as the content will be inadequate for setting questions. Make sure there is no overlapping or repetitions in the question you have set. Alternatively you can use two different texts for these two test items.

The marks allocated for information transfer is $1 \times 5 = 5$ or $0.5 \times 10 = 5$ (depending on the level of difficulty)

7. Substitution table

It's a grammar test item. It tests whether students can make grammatically correct sentences following any particular structure/s. It's different from matching item. In matching there might be equal number of texts in each column in a table and students need to make sentences using a text from each column. In designing the test item, the question setter can write the texts in Column A in a way so that the sequential arrangement of the text makes a context. In a substitution table, depending on marks, there will be 4 or 5 texts in the left column, 1 or 2 grammar words that shows the form in the middle column, and extensions at the right column. Each meaningful sentence made using the texts and the lexical word will have credit.

8. Gap filling with right forms of verbs

Sentences will be written in context in the question paper. Some verbs could be omitted or given in brackets without any form. If the verbs are totally omitted in the text, a list of verbs will be supplied in a box separately. Students' job will be to use the verb at the gaps in their correct forms according to the context and other grammatical considerations. Alternatively base form of verbs can also be supplied in the body of the text in parenthesis.

Students will write only the right answers with the question number. However, if anyone uses the text with words at the gaps, it should be accepted as correct answer.

9. Changing sentences

A text will be designed with a certain context. Some of the sentences in the text will have instructions in the parenthesis on how to change them. Depending on the marks in the test item, students will be asked to change 5 or 10 sentences. Students will write only the changed sentence as their answers. They can write the changed sentences in any order but must use the correct number used for each sentence in the given text.

10. Rearranging

Rearranging measures students' ability to organize some detached sentences into a coherent and cohesive text. Use 10 detached sentences for classes 6, 7, and 8 (See the

sample questions for these grades.). For SSC, Ss will rearrange eight parts of a story/passage (See the sample question for SSC.). Test your test item (with someone else or you sit for a test) to check whether the sequence of the answer vary. If the answer varies and each variety has a complete meaning, redesign the test. Use linking words/sentence connectors to maintain cohesion and coherence in the text. Learners do not need to reproduce the text in their answer scripts. If they arrange the corresponding serial of the texts correctly (such as b. d. a, f or v, iii, vi. i ... etc), they will get full credit. **Please remember that the test objective here is the organisation of sentences, not the copying of texts from the question paper.** However if any learner comes with sentences written in a random text, there is no need to penalize him/her. Students will get credits for the correct answers. For example, if the answer is like this:

a. X b. ✓ c. ✓ d. X e. ✓ f. ✓ g. X h. X i. ✓ j. X the student will get 5 marks.

The test has no relation with the texts used in the previous test items.

11. Writing summary

Use a text not exceeding 150 to 200 words for classes 6 to 8 and not exceeding 300 words for classes 9-10 in the question paper. Learners will produce a summary using one third words of the given text. For an example, if the original text has 150 words, learners will produce the summary in 50 words. However, 5% plus minus is okay. This answer should be written in random texts not in isolated sentences. There is no question of counting number of sentences in summary. So DO Not mention in the question paper how many lines or sentences learners will use to make a summary. The number of words used here is important. Make sure that they are writing in their own words, not copying some sentences from the text. Practice them to avoid examples or explanations in writing a summary. A fresh text should be given to make summary. No text used in the previous test items can be used here.

12. Writing a paragraph answering questions

Make sure while answering questions your students will be guided to write a well structured paragraph. In other words, if the students answer the questions properly, there will be a paragraph of a befitting topic sentence followed by arguments/ideas to support the topic sentence and a conclusion to summarise what has been told in the topic sentence and the body. There cannot be any new ideas in the conclusion. However, if there are 5 questions to answer, it does not mean that students will write only five sentences. They will use sentences as per their discretion but the paragraph as a whole answer the questions. If there are 10 marks for this item, learners should be able to make at least 10 sentences. The word limit for classes 6-7 is 150 words, for class

8, it is 170 words, and for 9-10 it is 200 words at least. 10% plus minus can be accepted. Keep an eye on the content rather than the mechanical calculation of sentences. **Assess the paragraph from different aspects such as grammar, ideas, organisation of ideas, communication, punctuation, and spelling.** Do not assess the paragraph from the perspective of grammar accuracy only. Regarding the composition writing in Paper 2 (which is structurally an essay) the word limit will be 250 for classes 6-7, 300 for class 8, and 350 for 9-10.

13. Completing a story

There will be the beginning of a story in the question paper. Students will continue the story and complete it. The answer will vary here. Completing a story when given at classes 6-8 should be more guided (See sample question for classes 6-7.) where question setter not only begins a story but also provides with some clues for the extension of ideas. Students will complete the story following the clues. A good idea is to mention the word limit when there is no clues for the students. Assess the paragraph from different aspects such as grammar, ideas, communication, organisation etc.; do not only assess the paragraph only from the perspective of grammar accuracy. Moreover, use of cohesion (inter-connectedness of the sentences) and coherence (transition from one idea to another idea) are important here. Word limit here will be similar to paragraph writing.

14. Open-Ended Questions

Open ended or essay format questions are excellent for measuring higher level cognitive learning and overall comprehension of a reading text/passage. They allow the student to select content for their response, to organize their thoughts in a logical manner and to present their ideas on a given subject matter. Overall, these types of test questions allow teachers to test student's broader understanding of a reading item.

When writing good open-ended questions, keep the following guidelines in mind:

- Be sure that the test question clearly states the answer that you are seeking from the student. For example, "Discuss the outcomes of environment pollution" is a poor test question. But, worded as "Describe the potential impacts of the environment pollution on the people of coastal regions in Bangladesh" or, what are the causes and impacts of environmental pollution on the people of coastal regions in Bangladesh? is a better test question as it clearly gives the student something to compare and contrast within a focused area.
- If you are looking to test comprehension, a good opening line for the test question is, 'Explain the following...'
- If you are seeking to test the student's ability to analyze a concept, a good opening phrase for your test question is, 'compare and contrast....'

- Don't give students the option to pick 2 or 3 questions from among 5. This can add confusion for the students and complexity for the teacher when grading for a classroom. This type of test format often compromises with validity and reliability of the test.
- Here you are setting recalling questions, design the question in a way so that examinees do not have opportunity to pick answers by matching the vocabulary in the question and answer.

Question setters have to go by the following class-wise guidelines in setting questions.

Grades 6-7

There will be 5 open ended questions each bearing 2 marks for the correct answer. There will be 2 questions for recalling answer, 2 questions to check students' understanding, and 1 question for analyzing information.

Grade 8

There will be 5 open ended questions each bearing 2 marks for the correct answer. There will be 2 questions for recalling answer, 2 questions to check students' understanding, and 1 question for analyzing information.

Grade 9-10

There will be 5 open ended questions each bearing 2 marks for the correct answer. There will be 1 question to recall answer, 3 questions to check students' understanding, 1 question for analysing information or evaluating something.

A list of action verbs according to Bloom's Taxonomy for lower order and higher order thinking questions are supplied here to be used while designing the test items.

Remembering/recalling: describe, define, list, locate, tell

Understanding: describe, classify, discuss, explain, identify, select, translate, predict

Analysing: solve, use, interpret, sketch, illustrate, classify, differentiate, organise, relate, identify, categorise, compare, contrast, construct, distinguish, explain,

Evaluating: argue, defend, judge, select, support, value, critique, assess, justify

Creating: construct, develop, investigate, design, imagine, justify

(for more information please visit:

<http://cft.vanderbilt.edu/guides-sub-pages/blooms-taxonomy/>)

15. Dialogue writing

A dialogue in real situation is an exchange of information. This has to be reflected in the dialogue written by the test giver. A dialogue **cannot** be a mere combination of fragmented sentences or snappy phrases or collocations like *Hi/Hello/Yes/No/Very good/Thank you/Welcome/See you/Bye etc.* There must be some questions and answers in full sentences. A dialogue has to contain at least 5 questions and their answers or 10 exchange of statements including some questions in full sentences other than greetings.

16. Writing letters/e-mails

If it is an informal letter, content is important. If it is a formal letter, both content and form are important. Formal letter can be written either in British style (each paragraph indented at the beginning for one space, date at the upper right hand corner, name at the right hand corner at the bottom). It can also be written in American style (All paragraphs in a line without indenting, date name everything at the left hand corner). Picture of an envelope or stamp is not needed but address can be written. Yet, if any student provides them - it will not earn any extra credit or penalty.

For e-mails, student must write the e-mail id, subject, and content as written in a genuine email. Students should be taught in the class that there should be a considerable margin at the answer script. However, there should not be any penalty for any examinee if the answer script has no margin. Margin has nothing to do with assessment of the answer.

Word limit should be mentioned in the question paper. Again the word limit is 150 words for classes 6-7, 170 words for class 8, and 200 for classes 9-10 with 10% plus minus.

17. Describing graphs and charts

Graph should be authentic. Teachers may collect charts from various sources such as newspapers, magazines, books or from the internet. Alternatively, teachers can use authentic data and make simple charts by themselves. Describing a graph or chart needs certain language abilities. The graph and chart presented in the textbook show that. A marker of answer scripts should keep an eye whether those languages are used or not. Answers will include the written presentation of data shown in the graph followed by a concluding remark. A question setter should mention the word limit for describing the graph or chart. Do not ask students to produce any graph on the answer sheet. They will only describe it.

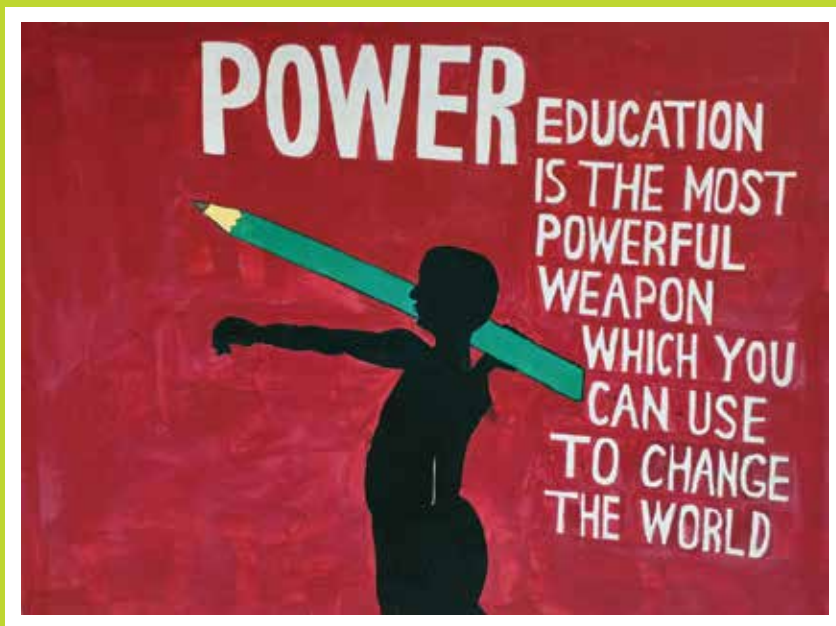
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Class Eight : English Grammar and Composition

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